

Castle Rock State Park Climbing Trip

October 10 to 11, 2026 | With Jordan Torres and Sarah Brennan

Trip ID	TRIP-CR-OCT2026
Dates	Saturday October 10, 2026 (day 1) and Sunday October 11, 2026 (day 2)
Location	Castle Rock State Park, 15000 Skyline Blvd, Los Gatos CA 95033
Party	Stephanie Wells (driver), Jordan Torres, Sarah Brennan
Grade focus	V5 to V7 boulders, slab and overhang variety
Drive time	Approximately 1 hour from Mission District, San Francisco
Camping	Saratoga Gap Environmental Campground (permit required)
Purpose	Annual fall bouldering pilgrimage and wedding-week wind-down

1. Objectives

This trip combines the annual fall outdoor climbing tradition with a much-needed decompression weekend following the Northstar feature freeze (October 9) and ahead of the annual physical (October 15) and the wedding (October 17). The goal is to get on real rock with Jordan and Sarah, attempt at least one V6 outdoor send, and arrive back in San Francisco mentally reset for the wedding week. Jordan will bring photography equipment and document the trip for the climbing blog and the climbing blog.

2. Itinerary

Time	Day	Activity
6:30 AM	Sat	Depart SF (2847 Valencia St). Jordan and Sarah meet at the car.
8:00 AM	Sat	Arrive Castle Rock. Trail coffee from thermos.
8:30 AM	Sat	Warm up on V2 to V4 problems, Terrace Boulder area.
10:00 AM	Sat	Move to Main Wall. Project V6 problems (Castle Rock slab).
1:00 PM	Sat	Lunch at picnic area. Pack in: grain bowls (prepped Sunday).
2:00 PM	Sat	Afternoon session: Goat Rock area V5 to V7 traverse.
4:30 PM	Sat	Set up camp at Saratoga Gap. Jordan leads fire (permit obtained).
6:00 PM	Sat	Dinner: veggie chili and cornbread over camp stove.
8:00 PM	Sat	Debrief the day, game of Codenames by headlamp.
6:30 AM	Sun	Morning coffee and oatmeal. Pack-out by 8:00 AM.
8:00 AM	Sun	Return to Castle Rock. Second session: unfinished V6 problems.
11:30 AM	Sun	Pack up. Drive back to SF.
1:30 PM	Sun	Drop Jordan and Sarah. Home by 2:00 PM.
3:00 PM	Sun	Sunday meal prep for wedding week. Grandma call rescheduled Sat.

3. Gear List

Item	Owner	Notes
Climbing shoes	Each	Personal fit; bring a backup pair
Chalk bag and chalk	Each	Extra block chalk for outdoor texture
Brush set	Stephanie	Stiff nylon for gritstone holds
Crash pads (x2)	Ridgeline	Borrowed from Ridgeline gym loaner program
Harness	N/A	Bouldering only; no harness needed
Approach shoes	Each	For trail access between boulder fields
First aid kit	Stephanie	Personal kit, includes tape for fingers
Headlamp	Each	Essential for early morning access
Water (3L per person)	Each	No reliable water source on trail
Food: day 1 lunch	Stephanie	Prepped Sunday grain bowls in cooler
Camp stove and fuel	Jordan	MSR camp stove, isobutane canister
Camp dinner	Sarah	Veggie chili (can + fixings)
Tent (2-person)	Jordan	Bivy option if permit allows
Sleeping bag (40F+)	Each	October nights at 2,000 ft, expect 45 to 55F
the satellite communicator	Stephanie	Backcountry safety device, always on
Camera	Jordan	Mirrorless for trip documentation

4. Key Logistics

- Camping permit: Saratoga Gap Environmental Campground, reserved via Reserve California. Permit number: SAR-2026-10B-0342. Print a copy.
- Park pass: California State Parks day-use fee \$8/vehicle. Annual pass covers this.
- Trail access: Park at the Castle Rock main lot off Skyline Blvd. 0.4-mile approach to the main boulder field.
- Shoulder notes: Stephanie will tape left shoulder before each session and limit overhang volume to 40 percent of total problems to protect the impingement.
- Cell service: unreliable at Castle Rock. the satellite communicator active for check-ins with Matt (415-555-0142) at 8 AM and 6 PM each day.
- Wedding context: This trip is 7 days before the wedding. Keep session volume moderate; no hero attempts that risk a sprained finger. Jordan agrees.
- Grandma call: rescheduled from Sunday to Saturday morning at 9 AM (on the road). Stephanie to call from car on Bluetooth.

5. Target Problems

Problem Name	Grade	Area	Style	Attempt Goal
Sandstone Classic	V5	Main Wall	Slab	Send
Skyline Traverse	V6	Terrace	Horizontal	Send
Goat Arete	V6	Goat Rock	Overhang	Send or red-point
Castle Start Direct	V7	Castle Wall	Crimp	Attempt, no expectation
Warm-up Circuit	V2 to V4	All areas	Varied	Warm up each session

6. Emergency Contacts and Plan

Matt Collins (SF)	(415) 555-0142 (check-in contact)
the satellite communicator	Emergency SOS available; Matt notified on activation
Park emergency	911 (cell service limited; the satellite communicator SOS preferred)
Nearest ER	Good Samaritan Hospital, Los Gatos (8 miles)
Nearest urgent care	MinuteClinic, Los Gatos (10 miles)
Dr. Amy Chen (shoulder)	(415) 555-0345, contact if shoulder injury
Evacuation plan	Jordan has car; anyone injured exits via Skyline Blvd to Hwy 9